

US 114051 · NQF LEVEL 5 · 4 CREDITS

# Conduct a Technical Practitioners Meeting



Meeting types, leadership styles and decision-making — then prepare, chair and follow up a technical meeting of your own

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| TIME                             | SESSIONS                                 | MODULE                          | QUALITY ASSURANCE |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|
| 90-minute lessons · Self & Group | Fridays, 4 & 11 Sep 2026 · 09h00 – 14h00 | Module 1 · Personal Development | QCTO / MICT SETA  |

# What you must be able to do

Four specific outcomes take you from knowing how meetings work to running one end-to-end. You will be assessed against these:



### 1 · Know the meetings

Describe the types of technical meetings and their uses; identify leadership styles, decision-making processes and meeting conventions.



### 2 · Prepare

Venue, facilities, technology and supporting information in place; clear documented outcomes; timeous invitations; agenda distributed.



### 3 · Chair

Establish rules with members, apply agreed conventions, follow the agenda, enable participation, prioritise topics, land clear decisions.



### 4 · Follow up

Accurate minutes per organisational policy; decisions communicated in the required format and timeframe; actions summarised.

# Why technical practitioners meet

- Meetings are very important for the work of any organisation — they are where the technical team decides, plans and holds itself accountable.
- Good meetings support collective decision-making, planning and follow-up, accountability and democracy.
- The principal activities of a technical committee are the development and maintenance of its standards, technical reports and data files.
- A badly run meeting wastes the scarcest resource a technical team has — its practitioners' time.

✓ By the end of this unit you will have prepared, chaired and minuted a technical practitioners meeting yourself — that is the evidence in your logbook.

# Three meetings you must know

Organisations hold many kinds of meetings — general members, special, executive, AGMs. For technical practitioners, three types matter most:



### Contract meetings

Discuss, review and manage contractual obligations and deliverables related to technical projects or services.



### Technical review meetings

Evaluate technical solutions, designs and implementations, and resolve technical issues and problems.



### Project review meetings

Assess project progress, timelines, resource allocation and project deliverables.

# Who decides — the chair, the group, or both?

Three main leadership styles are used in meeting procedures. Choose the style that fits the meeting's purpose:



### **Democratic**

The members decide through discussion and voting. The chair guides the process, but the group makes the decision.



### **Autocratic**

The chairperson controls the meeting and takes the decisions; members give input only when asked. Fast — use with care.



### **Facilitative**

A group effort: the facilitator guides the process while staying neutral, and the group produces the outcome together.

# Five ways meetings reach a decision

### **Voting**

Each member votes; the option with the majority is adopted.

### **Consensus**

Discussion continues until every member can accept the decision.

### **Criteria-based rating**

Score options against agreed criteria — the highest score wins.

### **Ranking**

Members order the options by preference; rankings are combined.

### **Paired comparisons**

Compare options two at a time; the overall winner is selected.

### **Match the process**

Pick the process that fits the decision's importance, urgency and need for buy-in.

# Order, fairness and effective decisions



### Moving

Formally propose a motion for the meeting to consider.



### Seconding

A second member supports the motion — unseconded motions fall away.



### Amending

Modify the motion before the vote; amendments are voted on first.



### Voting procedures

Show of hands, ballot or poll — counted and recorded by the chair.



The note taker needs a technical background — minutes must capture the terminology, decisions and reasons accurately.

# Physical arrangements — nothing left to chance

Preparation is where a meeting is won. Four arrangements must be in place before anyone walks in:



## Venue

Booked, accessible and set up for the meeting style — seating that lets practitioners face each other.



## Facilities

Whiteboards, flip charts, stationery, refreshments — everything the discussion will need.



## Technology

Projector, video conferencing, network access — prepared and tested before the meeting starts.



## Supporting information

Reports, designs and data the discussion depends on — available to every participant.

# Outcomes, invitations and the agenda



## Document the outcomes

Intended outcomes must be clear, concise and well documented — the agenda is built around them and success is measured against them.



## Invite timeously

Early invitations let participants prepare, study the documentation and arrange their schedules — so the right people attend.



## Complete & distribute the agenda

The agenda and supporting documentation are completed and distributed to all participants before the meeting.

*An agenda states the meeting's purpose, lists the items in priority order, and shows the time allocated to each.*

# Open with rules the members own

### ESTABLISH RULES & GUIDELINES

- Agree the rules in conjunction with the members at the start
- How to get the floor, how long contributions may run
- How decisions will be taken — and what is in scope
- Agreed rules create buy-in and prevent procedural disputes

### APPLY THE AGREED CONVENTIONS

- Run motions through moving, seconding and amending
- Follow the published agenda item by item
- Park unrelated issues and keep an eye on the clock
- Apply the conventions consistently — the same rules for everyone

# Participation, priorities and decisions

- Provide for active participation by ALL members — invite quiet members by name, use round-robin turns, acknowledge every contribution.
- Keep debate on the issue, not the person — that is how conflict is minimised.
- Prioritise topics and allocate discussion time according to importance, urgency and complexity.
- Move minor items to the end of the agenda — or carry them over to the next meeting.
- Ensure agreed decisions are clear, accurate and include a time frame for action.
- Confirm each decision — and who owns it — with the members before moving on.

# Managing difficult behaviours

| Behaviour                  | What the chair does                                                                     |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The heckler                | Stay calm; acknowledge any valid point and return to the agenda and agreed rules.       |
| The overly talkative       | Thank them, summarise their point, and invite someone who has not yet spoken.           |
| The cynic                  | Ask for evidence and an alternative — turn the criticism into an agenda item or action. |
| The silent member          | Invite their input by name on a topic they know well.                                   |
| Conflicting egos           | Keep debate on the issue, not the person; restate the meeting's outcomes.               |
| Side conversations         | Pause the meeting and draw the conversation back to the floor.                          |
| Factually wrong statements | Correct tactfully with the facts — or park the point for verification and record it.    |

# The meeting is not over when it ends



### Accurate minutes

Attendance, discussions, decisions and actions — produced in line with organisational policy and checked before distribution.



### Communicate decisions

To all affected stakeholders, in the required format — minutes, e-mail or report — and within the required timeframe.



### Summarise actions

Each action with its owner and deadline; unresolved items carried over to the next agenda.

*Decisions that are not communicated and tracked might as well not have been taken.*

## Your work for this unit standard



### Questioning sessions

Four AI-marked questioning exercises — meeting types, preparation, chairing and follow-up.



### Knowledge check quizzes

Four quizzes across the unit. 80%+ is competent.



### Chair a meeting

Role-play practical on Day 2 — every learner chairs a 10-minute technical meeting from a scenario card.



### Logbook project — Meeting portfolio

Notice and agenda, invitations, attendance register, minutes and action summary. Mark it 114051.



# Run the meeting — don't let the meeting run you.

Meeting types » leadership styles » decision processes » conventions » preparation » chairing » follow-up — the meeting skills every technical practitioner needs to turn discussion into action.